Google Analytics Overview

ITSS 3390

Prepared by: Angela Neal

Background: What is Web Analytics?

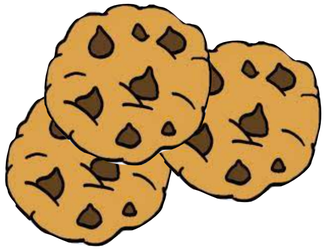
- The measurement and analysis of website Traffic and Conversions
- Web analytics can further be defined as the capture or collection, reporting, and analyzing data that is generated from those visiting or interacting with a website.
- It is a process of defining (business) goals, establishing measurements, analyzing findings, and acting on the results.

Background:Why Web Analytics?

- The *basic* purpose of using web analytics is to understand the online presence of a website with the intent to:
  - optimize the site
  - improve marketing
- Web analytics is used to understand visitor behavior in order to optimize the site - conversion processes, navigation, campaigns, aesthetics, etc.

Background: Two Requirements for Tracking Data

Cookies



- Identifies individual website users
- Gathers data as users travel through the site
- If a user has blocked cookies through the browser, then Google Analytics will not capture information on the user

JavaScript Tracking Code

- (Global site tag) Code must be placed on every webpage
- Essential for sending data to the Google servers

Terms

Hits

- User interactions with web site and page content. A hit is a distinct action.
- There are 3 types of hits
  - Page tracking
  - Event tracking
  - Ecommerce tracking

Examples of types of hits

Page loads, page view

Button click, page scroll

Product click. cart add, checkout

Terms

Session

- A visit to the website within a given timeframe
- A group of hits (in a given timeframe)
- A single user can open multiple sessions

User

- Visitor to the web site
- Identified by a Client ID which is stored in browser cookies
- Can track the same user across multiple sessions (with the Client ID)

Terms

New vs Returning Users

- Unique Client ID (cid) means a unique user
- A new user record is created if a new ID is detected
- If an ID exists, the user is considered to be returning (for the period observed)
- Limited due to browser cookies

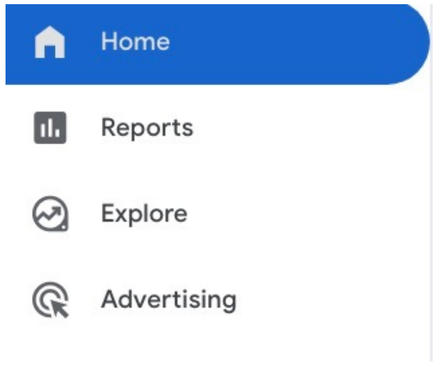
Access to Google Analytics

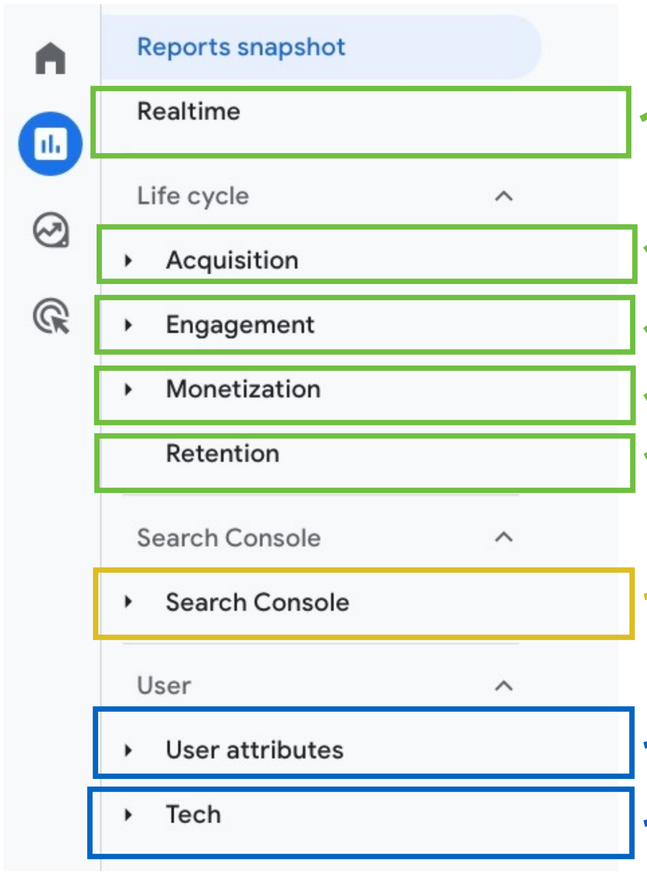
Google Analytics 4 property: Google Merchandise Store (web data)

- Data is from the Google Merchandise Store
- Includes typical data for an eCommerce site
  - Traffic source data: Information on where website users originate
  - Content data: Information on behavior of users on the website
  - Transaction data: Information on transactions on the website

Review Google Analytics Navigation

Google Analytics 4 (GA4)





Happening Now

Where did they come from?

What did they do?

Monetization: Revenue, Purchases, Purchase Path, etc.

Retention: User retention reports

Google organic search queries and traffic

Who are they?

Tech: Devices, browsers, etc used

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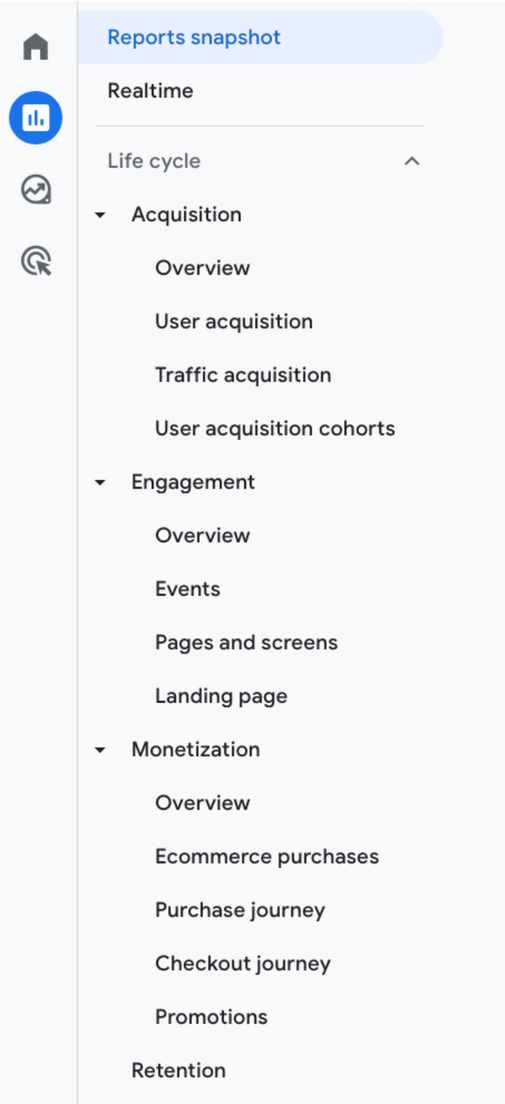

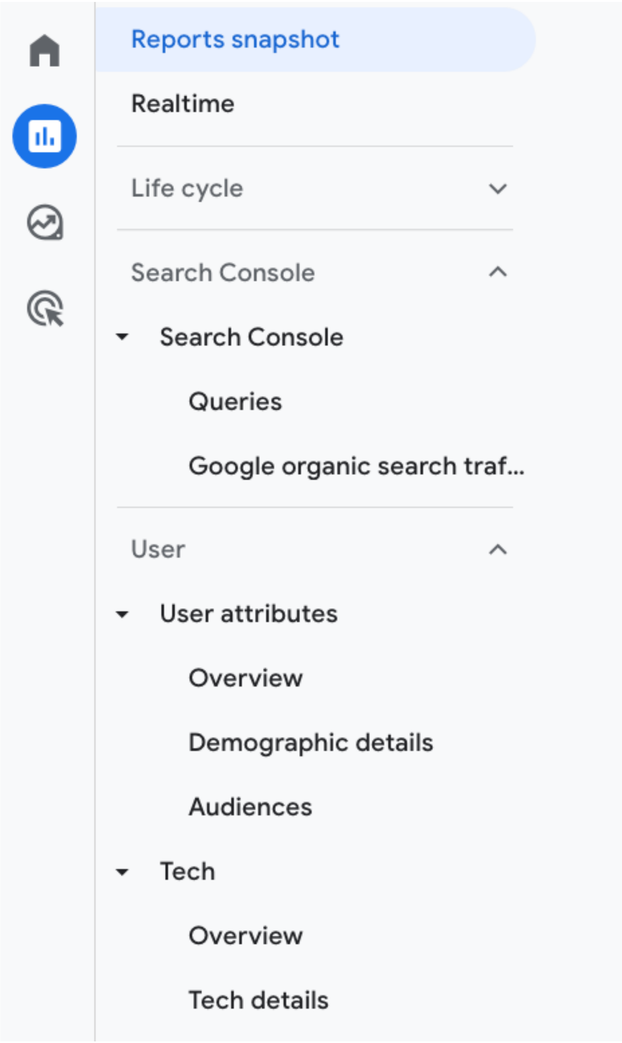

Hands-on with Google Analytics (GA4)

- Exploring features
- Open the **Realtime Overview** report
- Open the **Acquisition Overview** report
- Open the **Engagement Overview** report
- Open the **Monetization Overview** report
- Open the **Retention** report
- Open the **User attributes Overview** report
- Open the Tech Overview report

Helpful Resources or Sources

Google Analytics Answers